

London



Brussels



New York



Hong Kong



Moscow



TIME ZONES

The Italian mathematician Quirico Filopanti proposed a worldwide system of time zones in 1858, as did the Scottish-born Canadian Sir Sandford Fleming in 1879. Filopanti suggested that time zones be centered on Rome's meridian, while Fleming proposed that the Greenwich Meridian become the international standard for zero degrees, from which 24 hourly time zones are calculated.

▲ TIME DIFFERENCE ACROSS THE WORLD

Each 15 degrees of longitude from Greenwich adds or subtracts one full hour.

Steel sculpture on the prime meridian, pointing at the North Star

GREENWICH MEAN TIME

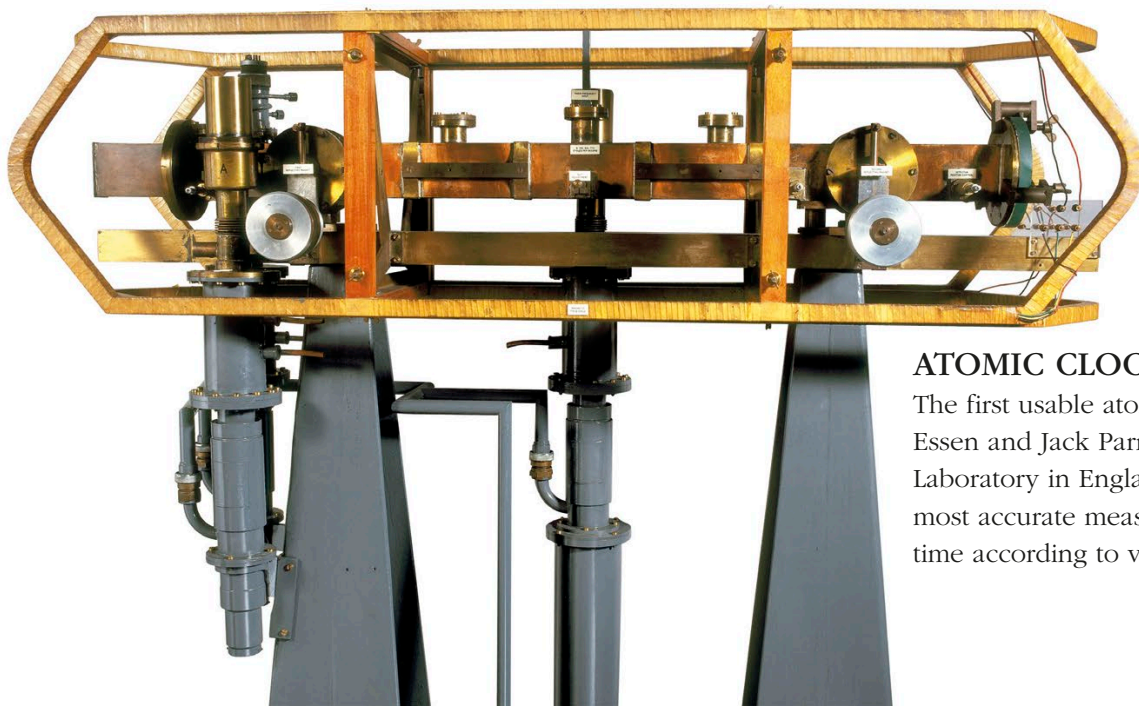
At the International Meridian Conference, held in October 1884 in Washington, D.C., delegates decided on Greenwich, UK, as the meridian to be employed as a common zero of longitude.

The prime meridian is symbolized by a steel strip.



WOW!

NIST-F1, an atomic clock in the US, is said to be so accurate that it would neither gain nor lose a second in over 30 million years.



◀ THE FIRST ATOMIC CLOCK

The world's first properly functioning atomic clock, which was built in 1955.

ATOMIC CLOCK

The first usable atomic clock, built by Louis Essen and Jack Parry at the National Physical Laboratory in England in 1955, provides the most accurate measure of time. It measures time according to vibrations within atoms.